

STRATEGIC DOCUMENT

NEXUS AI

Pricing & Financial Study

Research-Backed Packaging Strategy for AI Marketing SaaS

DOCUMENT TYPE

Strategic Pricing Analysis

RESEARCH BASIS

Industry Data + Competitor Benchmarks

COVERAGE

3 Packages + Financial Projections

DATE

2025 — Pre-Launch Edition

Executive Summary

This document presents a **research-driven pricing strategy** for NEXUS AI — an AI-powered marketing operating system targeting SMBs and agencies in the MENA region and globally. The pricing framework is built on three pillars: **(1) marketing science** — how many posts actually drive business results, **(2) competitive positioning** — where NEXUS sits relative to existing tools, and **(3) unit economics** — ensuring sustainable gross margins at each tier.



Conclusion of this study:

NEXUS AI should offer **three tiers** — Starter, Growth, and Agency — priced at **\$19, \$49, and \$99/month** respectively. These numbers are not arbitrary: they are derived from optimal content frequencies per platform, competitor benchmarks, and a cost model that maintains 60-75% gross margins. The Starter tier targets solo entrepreneurs who are just starting with content. Growth is the conversion engine — positioned as the "serious marketer" plan. Agency serves teams managing multiple brands.

1

Marketing Research: Optimal Posting Frequency

How many posts/month actually drive measurable business outcomes?

Before setting post limits in any pricing tier, we must answer a foundational question: **how many posts per month are needed to generate real marketing results?** This section synthesizes research from HubSpot, Sprout Social, Buffer, and SocialInsider — the leading social media analytics platforms globally.

1.1 — The 16-Post Threshold

HubSpot’s State of Marketing Report consistently shows that businesses publishing **16+ blog or social posts per month generate 4.5x more leads** than those publishing 4 or fewer. This metric has been stable across multiple years and across both B2B and B2C categories. The mechanism is simple: frequency drives algorithm visibility, which drives reach, which drives conversions.

Key Insight: 16 posts/month is the research-backed minimum for meaningful lead generation. This becomes our Growth tier baseline.

1.2 — Platform-by-Platform Optimal Frequency

Platform	Optimal Posts/Week	Optimal Posts/Month	Best Format (2025)	Key Finding
Instagram	3–5x/week	12–20/month	Reels + Carousels	Reels get 3x more reach than static posts
LinkedIn	2–3x/week	8–12/month	Text + Documents	Document posts get 3x avg impressions
TikTok	2–5x/week	8–20/month	Short-form Video	11+/week shows 34% more profile views
Facebook	1–2x/week	4–8/month	Video + Stories	Organic reach limited — quality > volume
Twitter/X	5–7x/week	20–30/month	Threads + Polls	High frequency needed due to short content life

Platform	Optimal Posts/Week	Optimal Posts/Month	Best Format (2025)	Key Finding
YouTube (Shorts)	2–3x/week	8–12/month	Shorts + Long-form	Shorts drive subscriber growth effectively

Sources: Sprout Social Index 2024, Buffer State of Social 2024, HubSpot Marketing Report 2024, SocialInsider Benchmark Report 2024

1.3 — Synthesized Monthly Volume by User Tier

Based on the platform research above, we can define three natural user segments by the volume of content they need monthly:

User Profile	Monthly Post Need	Platforms Typically Used	Expected Outcome
Solo Entrepreneur / Testing	8–12 posts/mo	1–2 platforms (IG + LinkedIn)	Brand presence, low lead gen
Serious SMB / Growing Brand	16–25 posts/mo	2–3 platforms (IG + LI + TikTok)	4.5x leads vs. low-frequency brands
Agency / Multi-Brand Manager	30–60+ posts/mo	All platforms, multiple clients	Full marketing operations management

2

Competitor Landscape Analysis

Where does NEXUS AI sit relative to existing tools?

Understanding the competitive landscape is essential for pricing that feels justified to buyers. We analyzed 6 categories of competing tools across scheduling, AI writing, and full-suite social platforms.

Tool	Category	Pricing	Post Limit	AI Features	Key Gap vs NEXUS
Buffer	Scheduler	\$6–\$12/c h/mo	Unlimited	Basic AI assist	No strategy, no campaign AI, no brand memory
Hootsuite	Suite	\$99–\$249/mo	Unlimited	OwlyWriter AI	Complex UX, no campaign planning, enterprise-only AI
Later	Scheduler	\$25–\$110/mo	30/pro file	Caption writer	No AI strategy, no campaign wizard, no brand brain
Jasper AI	AI Writing	\$39–\$59/mo	N/A (words)	GPT-4 writing	No scheduling, no strategy, no workflow
Copy.ai	AI Writing	\$0–\$49/mo	N/A (words)	GPT-4 copy	No campaign system, no scheduling integration
Sprout Social	Enterprise	\$79–\$399/mo	Unlimited	AI insights	Designed for large teams; expensive; no generative AI strategy
NEXUS AI	AI Marketing OS	\$19–\$99/mo	10–60/mo	Strategy + Captions + Storyboards + Campaign Memory	NEXUS IS the differentiated option

Source: Company websites (Buffer.com, Hootsuite.com, Later.com, Jasper.ai, Copy.ai, Sproutsocial.com) — pricing as of Q4 2024.

2.1 — Positioning Map

The competitive gap is clear: **no current tool combines AI strategy generation, campaign planning, brand memory, and content output at sub-\$100/month pricing.** Buffer and Later are schedulers. Jasper and Copy.ai are writing assistants. Hootsuite and Sprout are expensive enterprise platforms. **NEXUS AI occupies the empty middle ground:** an intelligent marketing operating

system accessible to growing brands and solo entrepreneurs.

- **vs. Schedulers (Buffer, Later):** NEXUS adds AI strategy + campaign planning on top. We justify 3-4x price premium with intelligence, not just scheduling.
- **vs. AI Writers (Jasper, Copy.ai):** NEXUS adds structure, workflow, and campaign context. Not just a blank AI editor — a guided marketing system.
- **vs. Enterprise (Hootsuite, Sprout):** NEXUS delivers 80% of the value at 20% of the cost. The SMB and agency mid-market is massively underserved.

3

Cost Structure & Unit Economics

What does it cost to deliver each campaign?

Accurate unit economics are non-negotiable for sustainable pricing. This section calculates the true cost of serving a NEXUS AI user — infrastructure, AI API calls, and overhead — to determine the minimum viable price per tier.

3.1 — AI API Costs (GPT-4o-mini)

NEXUS AI uses **GPT-4o-mini** as the primary inference engine for strategy, captions, hooks, CTAs, and storyboard generation. This model offers excellent quality at the lowest cost in OpenAI's portfolio.

Operation	Tokens (est.)	Cost per Call	Calls/Campaign	Total per Campaign
Brand Strategy Generation	~2,000 tokens	\$0.0012	1	\$0.0012
Campaign Hook Writing (5 hooks)	~800 tokens	\$0.00048	1	\$0.00048
Post Caption Generation (x10)	~500 tokens each	\$0.0003 each	10	\$0.003
CTA + Storyboard	~1,200 tokens	\$0.00072	1	\$0.00072
Content Calendar (30 days)	~1,500 tokens	\$0.0009	1	\$0.0009
TOTAL per full campaign (10 posts)	~8,000	—	—	~\$0.007

Pricing basis: GPT-4o-mini at \$0.15/1M input tokens, \$0.60/1M output tokens (OpenAI, Q4 2024).

3.2 — Infrastructure Cost (Early Stage)

Service	Tier Used	Monthly Cost (0-100 users)	Monthly Cost (100-500 users)
Vercel (Hosting)	Hobby/Pro	\$0 / \$20	\$20
Supabase (DB + Auth)	Free/Pro	\$0 / \$25	\$25
Cloudinary (Media)	Free/Plus	\$0	\$0–\$50

Service	Tier Used	Monthly Cost (0-100 users)	Monthly Cost (100-500 users)
Stripe (Billing)	Pay-per-use	2.9% of revenue	2.9% of revenue
Total Fixed Infra	—	~\$0–\$45/mo	~\$45–\$95/mo

3.3 — Per-User Monthly COGS

Combining AI costs and infrastructure per active paid user:

Cost Category	Starter User	Growth User	Agency User
AI API (campaigns generated)	\$0.05–\$0.10	\$0.10–\$0.25	\$0.25–\$0.80
Infra (allocated per user)	\$0.05	\$0.10	\$0.20
Stripe fee (on subscription)	\$0.55	\$1.42	\$2.87
Total COGS / user / month	~\$0.65–\$0.70	~\$1.60–\$1.80	~\$3.30–\$3.90
Gross Margin at \$19/\$49/\$99	96%+	96%+	96%+

Note: These are unit economics at typical usage levels. Heavy users (10+ campaigns/month) may reduce margins to ~90%. This is why the credit system exists — usage beyond the allotment drives upgrade or overage revenue.

4

The 3 Research-Backed Packages

Pricing built on marketing science, not guesswork

The three tiers below are calibrated to match the three natural user segments identified in Section 1. Each plan is justified by research-backed content frequency thresholds, competitive benchmarks from Section 2, and the unit economics from Section 3.

Package 1 — Starter

	Detail
Price	\$19/month (or \$15/mo billed annually)
Posts Included	10 AI-generated posts/month
Campaigns	2 campaigns/month (full wizard: strategy, hooks, captions, CTA)
AI Credits	50 AI credits/month
Workspaces	1 workspace (1 brand)
Platforms	2 social platforms connected
Features	Campaign wizard, brand brain, basic analytics, content calendar
Support	Email support
Target User	Freelancers, solopreneurs, early-stage startups testing content

Research Justification: 10 posts/month covers the minimum viable presence on 1-2 platforms. This is below the 16-post threshold for lead generation (the Growth tier crosses that threshold), making Starter a genuine starter plan — not a conversion engine. Priced at \$19 to be accessible and to create a strong upgrade pressure toward Growth.

Package 2 — Growth (Most Popular)

	Detail
Price	\$49/month (or \$39/mo billed annually)
Posts Included	25 AI-generated posts/month
Campaigns	5 campaigns/month (full output: strategy, hooks, captions, storyboard, CTA)

AI Credits	150 AI credits/month + overage at \$0.10/credit
Workspaces	3 workspaces (3 brands or clients)
Platforms	All platforms (unlimited connections)
Features	Everything in Starter + media uploads, campaign memory, content calendar, advanced analytics
Support	Priority email + chat support
Target User	SMBs, growing e-commerce brands, content creators, small agencies

Research Justification: 25 posts/month surpasses the critical 16-post threshold identified by HubSpot (4.5x leads benchmark), and aligns with the optimal frequency for 2-3 active platforms simultaneously. Priced at \$49 — positioned below Hootsuite and Sprout Social while delivering a comparable or superior AI-powered experience. The 2.5x price jump from Starter to Growth is justified by a 2.5x increase in post volume plus the addition of campaign memory, unlimited platforms, and multi-workspace capability.

Package 3 — Agency

	Detail
Price	\$99/month (or \$79/mo billed annually)
Posts Included	60 AI-generated posts/month
Campaigns	Unlimited campaigns/month
AI Credits	500 AI credits/month + overage at \$0.08/credit (volume discount)
Workspaces	10 workspaces (10 brands or clients)
Platforms	All platforms, all integrations
Features	Everything in Growth + white-label reports, team seats (2 included), API access, priority AI queue
Support	Dedicated Slack channel + onboarding call
Target User	Marketing agencies, in-house teams, enterprise SMBs managing multiple brands

Research Justification: 60 posts/month covers an agency managing 3-4 active clients at the 16-20 posts/month threshold each. The 2x jump from Growth to Agency is justified by: 2.4x post volume, unlimited campaigns, 10 workspaces, team seats, and white-label capabilities. Priced at \$99 — dramatically below Hootsuite (\$249) and Sprout Social (\$199+) for comparable output volume. For agencies, this is sub-\$10/client/month for full AI marketing capability.

Package Comparison Summary

Feature	Starter \$19/mo	Growth \$49/mo	Agency \$99/mo
AI Posts / Month	10	25	60
Campaigns / Month	2	5	Unlimited
AI Credits / Month	50	150	500
Workspaces (Brands)	1	3	10
Social Platforms	2	Unlimited	Unlimited
Campaign Memory (AI learns)	No	Yes	Yes

Feature	Starter \$19/mo	Growth \$49/mo	Agency \$99/mo
Media Uploads	No	Yes	Yes
Team Seats	1	1	2 (+\$19/extra)
White-Label Reports	No	No	Yes
API Access	No	No	Yes
COGS / month	~\$0.70	~\$1.80	~\$3.90
Gross Margin	96.3%	96.3%	96.1%

5

Revenue Projections

12-month MRR model based on realistic conversion scenarios

The following projections use conservative acquisition assumptions and a realistic plan distribution based on SaaS benchmarks: most users start on a free trial, upgrade to Starter, with a meaningful portion converting to Growth (the conversion engine), and a smaller Agency cohort.

5.1 — Assumed Plan Distribution (Paid Users)

Based on typical SaaS conversion patterns and competitor benchmarks for AI tools: **40% Starter, 45% Growth, 15% Agency**. The Growth plan is intentionally designed to be the most attractive option — its value proposition is strongest relative to its price.

Month	Total Paid Users	Starter (40%)	Growth (45%)	Agency (15%)	MRR	Gross Profit
Month 1	10	4	4	2	\$470	\$407 (87%)
Month 2	20	8	9	3	\$890	\$811 (91%)
Month 3	35	14	15	6	\$1,595	\$1,489 (93%)
Month 4	55	22	24	9	\$2,485	\$2,346 (94%)
Month 5	80	32	36	12	\$3,560	\$3,381 (95%)
Month 6	115	46	51	18	\$5,155	\$4,915 (95%)
Month 7	160	64	72	24	\$7,120	\$6,807 (96%)
Month 8	220	88	99	33	\$9,790	\$9,376 (96%)
Month 9	290	116	130	44	\$12,930	\$12,398 (96%)
Month 10	370	148	166	56	\$16,490	\$15,824 (96%)
Month 11	460	184	207	69	\$20,470	\$19,654 (96%)
Month 12	560	224	252	84	\$24,920	\$23,937 (96%)
Month 12 ARR	560	—	—	—	\$299,040	~96%

Note: Projections assume ~50 new signups/month by Month 6, growing to ~100/month by Month 12. Churn estimated at 5%/month (industry avg. for early-stage SaaS). Free tier users not included in MRR calculations.

6

Free Tier & Upgrade Strategy

How to convert users — not just retain them

6.1 — Free Tier Scope

A meaningful free tier is essential for viral growth and trust. It must be generous enough to show real value, but limited enough to create genuine upgrade desire.

Free Tier Includes	Limit	Why This Limit?
AI-generated posts	3/month	Enough to experience magic; not enough for a real content strategy
Campaigns	1 campaign/month	Full campaign wizard — demonstrate full value of product
AI Credits	10 credits/month	Resets monthly to keep user engaged
Workspaces	1	Full feature access — just volume-limited
Platforms connected	1	Forces upgrade to grow multi-platform presence
Exports	No (watermarked preview)	Export unlock is a key upgrade trigger
Campaign Memory	No	AI learning across campaigns is a premium differentiator

6.2 — Upgrade Trigger Architecture

Every limitation in the free tier must have a corresponding upgrade trigger that appears at the right moment. The goal is to create *desire*, not frustration.

Trigger: Credit limit reached

Show a modal: 'You've used all your AI credits this month. Upgrade to Growth for 150 credits.' — appears mid-session for maximum conversion

Trigger: Export attempted on free

'Unlock exports + remove watermarks' — simple, frictionless upsell at a moment of high intent

Trigger: 2nd platform connection

'Connect unlimited platforms with Growth' — surfaces in the Connections page naturally

Trigger: 3rd post attempted on free

Hard limit + upgrade prompt inline with the post editor — the user is already in the creation flow

Trigger: Campaign Memory locked

After a campaign, show: 'NEXUS learned from this campaign. Upgrade to Growth to let NEXUS remember your brand across all future campaigns.'

7

Final Recommendations

Implementation roadmap for the pricing system

7.1 — Immediate Actions

1. Update Stripe Products

Create 3 new Stripe products: nexus_starter_monthly (\$19), nexus_growth_monthly (\$49), nexus_agency_monthly (\$99). Add annual variants at 20% discount.

2. Update Billing Page

Rebuild the pricing page using the comparison table from Section 4. Highlight the Growth plan as 'Most Popular'. Show annual savings prominently.

3. Implement Credit System

The AI credit counter must be visible on every dashboard. Users should see credits depleting in real-time — this creates urgency to upgrade.

4. Wire Upgrade Triggers

Deploy the 5 upgrade trigger moments from Section 6.2 across the product. These are conversion multipliers.

5. Landing Page Pricing Section

Update landing page pricing section to reflect the new 3-tier structure with research citations embedded as social proof.

7.2 — Annual Billing Strategy

Offer annual billing at 20% discount (approximately 2 months free): Starter \$152/yr (\$15/mo effective), Growth \$470/yr (\$39/mo effective), Agency \$950/yr (\$79/mo effective). Annual billing improves cash flow and dramatically reduces churn. At scale, pushing 30-40% of paid users to annual billing is a key metric.

7.3 — North Star Metrics

Metric	Target
MRR Growth	>20% month-over-month in months 1-6

Metric	Target
Free-to-Paid Conversion	>8% (industry avg: 2-5%; NEXUS has strong triggers)
Starter-to-Growth Upgrade	>25% of Starter users upgrade within 60 days
Net Revenue Retention	>100% (expansion from upgrades + overages > churn)
Gross Margin	>93% (our model shows 96% — maintain this as scale increases AI usage)
Payback Period	<3 months per customer at Growth tier

This pricing strategy is built on real marketing research — not on intuition or round numbers. The 3 tiers map directly to the 3 natural user segments defined by content frequency science. The unit economics show that NEXUS AI can operate at 96%+ gross margins — exceptional even for SaaS. The Growth tier is designed to be the conversion engine: priced fairly, loaded with value, and positioned precisely at the research-proven 16+ posts/month lead generation threshold. **This is a business built to grow.**